

Principal Role: Easy Guide

Faculty Management System · How the Principal works, from login to the last task
Budget, emergency budget and purchase are not included · 9 Oct 2026

How to read this guide. Every flow is a list of numbered steps. A **plain white box** is someone else's step. A **shaded blue box with a dark border** is the Principal's step. A **green box** is the end. Read the first two pages and you know the whole role.

1. The role in one minute

The Principal is the **head of one college**. Think of the Principal as the person who says "**yes**", "**no**" or "**fix it first**".

1. DECIDE

Hiring requests, interview plans, candidates, staff leave.

2. LOOK

Students, timetable, marks, attendance, audit trail.

3. SET UP

Settings, job seats, departments, courses, circulars.

After every decision the system **tells the person who asked** and **writes a record** (an audit entry).

Who counts as "Principal"?

Login	What it can do
Principal	Everything in this guide.
Vice Principal (VP)	Almost the same pages and powers. Also has "General Admin Vacancies".
College Admin, Director	Can open the pages, but cannot decide hiring or leave. The server answers "403 not allowed".

2. Login to dashboard

- 1** **PRINCIPAL**
Opens the login page and types email and password.
- 2** **SYSTEM**
Checks the password (Firebase), finds the role and college, and saves a login cookie that lasts **24 hours**.
- 3** **SYSTEM**
Opens `/principal`. A page gate only lets this role into Principal pages.
- 4** **PRINCIPAL SEES**
The Dashboard.

Special case. If the Principal's staff record is marked **Resigned** or **Retired**, they can still log in but can only **read**. Every change is refused.

What the dashboard shows

Hello, Principal

Pending Vacancies
opens Hiring Requests

Interviews & Decisions
opens Interviews

Departments
opens Courses

Pending Hiring Requests
list with a "Review" button

Pending Interview Plans
list with a "Review" button

GAP The dashboard only shows **hiring**. There is no card for leave, attendance or students.

The menu (left side)

Dashboard
Home

Academics
Courses · Students · Timetable View · Internal Marks

Staff & HR
Faculty · Staff · Circulars

Leave & Attendance
Leave Approvals · Leave History · Attendance · Attendance Reports

Hiring
Hiring Requests (Interviews, Negotiate, Decisions, Appointment Letters come after it)

Personal
My Profile · My Attendance · My Leave

Administration
Audit Logs · Role Assignments · Settings

The Super Admin can hide menu items. Hiding is only for looks; the server checks every action again.

3. Can and cannot

Principal CAN

- **DECIDE** hiring request, interview plan, candidate, leave
- **CREATE** appointment letters, circulars, departments, courses, faculty, staff
- **ASSIGN** job seats (HOD, Exam Cell, Library...)
- **CHANGE** college settings, leave rules
- **LOOK** students, timetable, marks, attendance, audit log
- Promote students to the next year

Principal CANNOT

- Decide anything while logged in as **College Admin**
- Create class **sections** (only HOD)
- Enter or change **internal marks**
- Create **exam circulars** (only Exam Cell)
- Approve their **own leave** (goes to Management)
- See another college's data
- **Forward** or **reopen** a decision (not built)

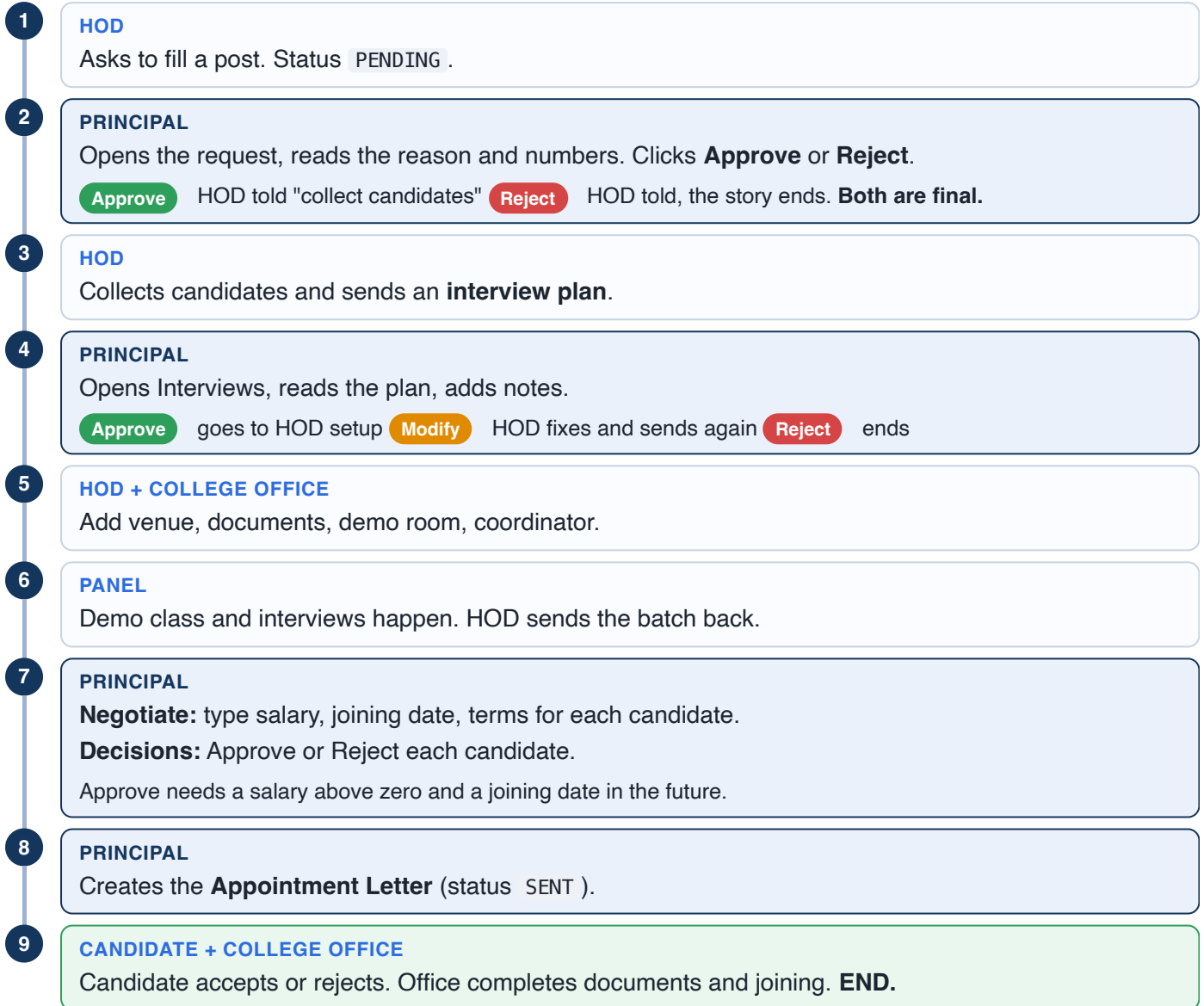
Permission table

V = view, C = create, E = edit, A = approve, R = reject, D = delete. "API only" = the server would allow it but the screen has no button.

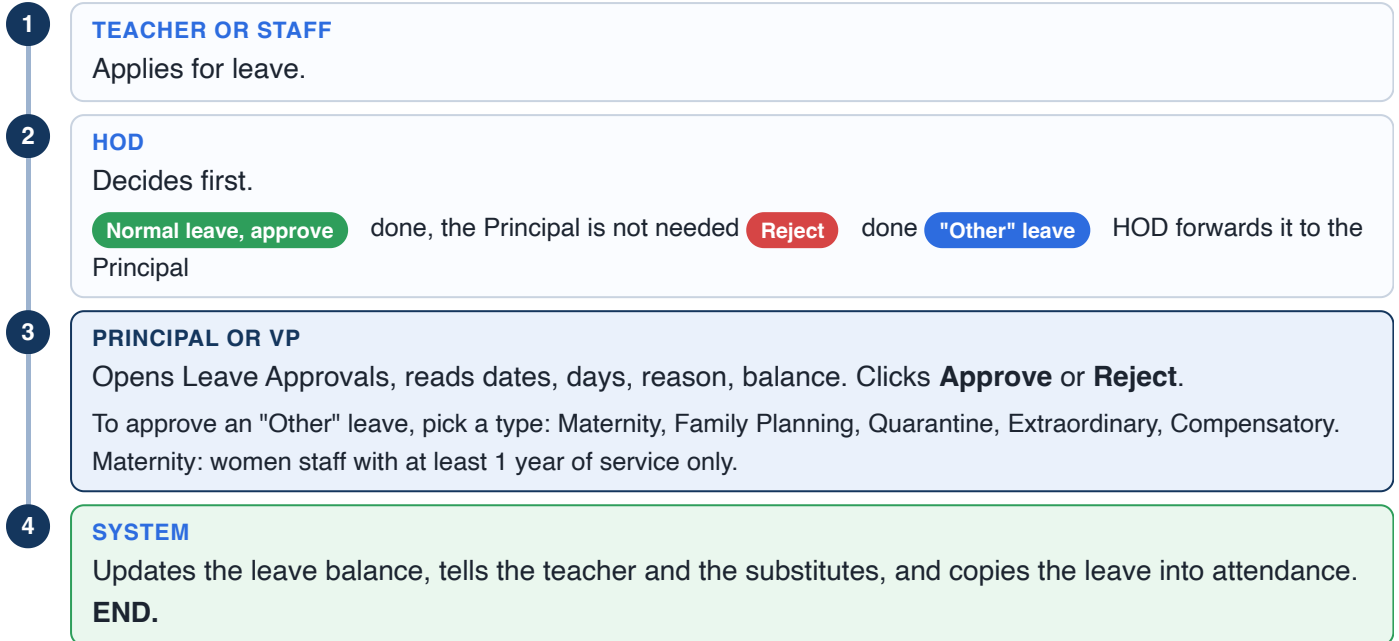
Area	Principal / VP	Other roles
Hiring request	V, A, R (final)	HOD creates
Interview plan	V, A, R, Modify	HOD sets up. Office adds venue
Candidate	A, R, set salary and joining date (final)	Panel scores
Appointment letter	V, C	Office, HOD, Accounts read
Leave	A, R at the final stage	HOD decides first stage
Circulars	V, C, E, publish	Others only if allowed
Faculty	V, C, E, D	HOD same. Office V only
Staff and users	V, C, E, D	HOD, Office: no delete
Departments	V, C, E, D	HOD, Super Admin
Courses	V, C (Principal only, not VP)	Super Admin creates
Sections	V only	HOD creates
Students	V, promote. API only: add, edit, delete	HOD, Office manage
Timetable	V. API only: edit, publish, reset	HOD builds
Internal marks	V only	Faculty enters
Audit logs	V (last 100)	none
Job seats	Assign, vacate, update, remove	Super Admin, Management
Settings	V, E	HOD reads Faculty Norms

4. Step-by-step flows

4.1 Hiring: from "we need a teacher" to "appointment letter"



4.2 Leave: who decides what

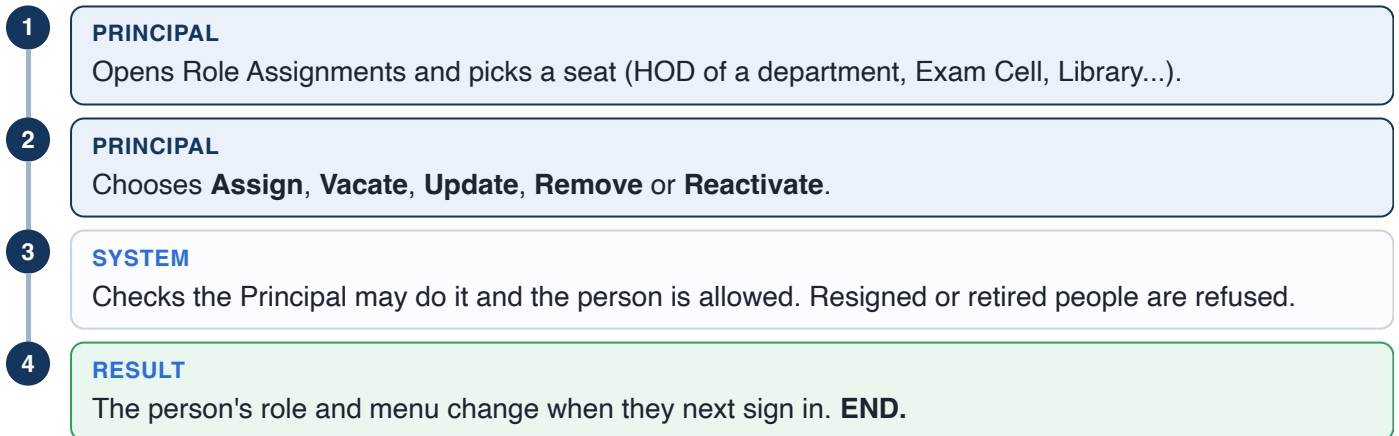


Who can decide?

Routed to the **Principal**: only the Principal.
Routed to the **VP**: VP or Principal.
A VP can never approve their own leave.

Principal's own leave goes to **Management**, not to the Leave Approvals screen.

4.3 Job seats (Role Assignments)



4.4 Circulars and student promotion

Circular: Write it (**DRAFT**) → Publish (**PUBLISHED**) → later Archive (**ARCHIVED**). **Nobody approves it** first.

Promotion: Students → Promotion tab → choose the group → confirm. Students move up one year. Last-year students become **Graduated**.

5. Module cards

Each card: what it is, what you see, what you can do, and what happens next.

Hiring Requests

[Decide](#)

What it is	The HOD asks for a new staff member. You say yes or no.
You see	Position, department, how many needed vs have, student count, HOD's reason.
You can	Approve or Reject (reason is optional).
Then	HOD and Department Office head get a message. A record is written.
Careful	The decision is final. Changing it gives "already decided" (409).

Interviews

[Decide](#)

What it is	You approve the plan for interviewing candidates.
You see	Position, candidates, panel, date, time, online or offline.
You can	Approve, Reject, Modify (with notes).
Then	Approve: HOD must add venue, documents, demo room and coordinator.
Phases	Principal review → HOD setup → Ready → In progress → Panel interview → Principal final review → Completed.

Negotiate and Decisions

[Decide](#)

What it is	Agree pay and joining date, then hire or not.
You can	Enter expected salary, agreed salary, joining date, terms. Then Approve or Reject each candidate.
Rules	Approve needs salary above 0 and a future joining date. Only Principal and VP can do this.
Then	When all candidates are decided, the batch is Completed. Issue the Appointment Letter.

Appointment Letters

[Create](#)

You can	Create a letter with pay (CTC), address and terms. Status becomes Sent.
Who	Principal, VP, Super Admin create. Office, HOD, Accounts can read.

Leave Approvals and Leave History

[Decide](#)[Look](#)

You see	Only requests waiting for you. History is by department, then person, then leave type.
You can	Approve or Reject with remarks. "Other" leave needs a type.
Safety	Balance changes happen in one step, so a double click cannot take the days twice. Days over the balance become Loss of Pay.
Then	Teacher and substitutes are told. Attendance is updated.

Faculty and Staff

Create Edit Delete

You see	Departments, then people, then their profile pages (personal, academic, teaching load, resume).
You can	Add one or import from Excel, edit, manage login details, delete a faculty record.
Automatic	Marking someone Resigned or Retired removes their job seats and makes their login read-only.
Careful	Delete only asks "are you sure". No approval.

Courses and Departments

Create Edit

You can	Create and edit departments and courses, set years taught and timings, edit the course catalog.
Rules	Empty "Years Taught" means not set , not "all years". You cannot remove a year while students, sections or timetable still use it (409).

Students

Look Promote

Tabs	Roster · Promotion · Graduated.
You see	Student list and strength numbers. Filter by course, department, year, section, or search. Click a row for details.
Screen	No Add, Edit or Delete buttons on purpose.
Careful	The server would still accept add, edit, delete.

Timetable View and Internal Marks

Look

Timetable	Published timetables only, by course-year and section. Read only.
Internal Marks	List with a read-only detail window. No edit, no approve.

Attendance and Attendance Reports

Look Import

Attendance	Daily staff check-in and check-out; import file; manual entry.
Reports	History, completion, absent, shortage, faculty not posted, student attendance. Filter by date, department, course, section.

Circulars

Create Publish

You can	Write, publish, archive. Choose which other people may send circulars.
Careful	There is no approval step before publishing.

Role Assignments

Assign

Seats	Principal, College Admin, Vice Principal, Academics, HOD (one per department), IQAC, T&P, R&D, R&D Coordinator, Placement, Exam Cell, Library, Webmaster.
Rule	One Principal, one VP, one College Admin per college.

Settings

Change

Cards	College Information · Faculty Norms · Student Permissions · Leave Module · Leave Approval Routing · Vacation Staff · Leave Type Rules.
Careful	Save works at once. No approval.

Audit Logs

Look

You see	The last 100 actions in your college, newest first.
Missing	No search, filter, export or next page.

My Profile · My Attendance · My Leave

Own

What	The Principal's own records. Hidden for College Admin. Own leave goes to Management.
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6. Who talks to whom

Other role	What starts it	What the Principal does	Where it ends
HOD	Vacancy request, interview plan, "Other" leave	Approves, rejects or sends back	HOD carries on, or it stops
Vice Principal	Shares the same work	Same powers (see section 3)	-
Teachers	Leave application	Views profile and history; decides "Other" leave	Leave approved or rejected
College Office	Enters data, offers, venue, documents	Makes the decisions	Office finishes joining
Students	-	Only views and promotes	No contact with the Principal
Management	Principal's own leave	Management decides	-
Super Admin	-	Chooses which menu items the Principal sees	-
Exam Cell, Library, IQAC...	-	Principal places people in these seats	-
Dean	-	No flow found	-

Messages and records

- Vacancy decision → HOD and Department Office head.
- Interview plan decision → department heads.
- Leave decision → teacher and substitutes.
- Batch ready for final review → all Principals.
- Every decision also writes an audit entry (who, when, what).

Status words you will see

Item	Statuses
Vacancy	PENDING, APPROVED, REJECTED, MODIFIED
Interview batch phase	PRINCIPAL_REVIEW, HOD_FINAL_SETUP, INTERVIEW_READY, IN_PROGRESS, PANEL_INTERVIEW, PRINCIPAL_FINAL_REVIEW, COMPLETED
Candidate	PENDING, ARRIVED, SHORTLISTED, APPROVED, REJECTED
Leave	PENDING_HOD, PENDING_PRINCIPAL, PENDING_VICE_PRINCIPAL, PENDING_MANAGEMENT, APPROVED, REJECTED, CANCELLED
Circular	DRAFT, PUBLISHED, ARCHIVED
Offer letter	DRAFT, SENT, ACCEPTED, REJECTED

7. What was tested

Check	Result
Reading the code that guards each action	DONE Passed, apart from the problems below
Route guard test (<code>routeGuards.inventory.test.ts</code>)	PENDING still running
Typecheck (<code>tsc --noEmit</code>) after my edits	PENDING still running
Clicking every button in a browser, direct links, back button, real API calls	NOT TESTED needs a seeded test database that was not confirmed
Playwright end-to-end tests	NOT RUN

Nothing was run against real college data.

8. The whole journey on one page

Login → **Dashboard** → **Hiring Requests** → **Approve** / **Reject** → HOD told
→ **Interviews** → **Approve** / **Modify** / **Reject** → HOD sets up
→ **Negotiate** (salary, joining date) → **Decisions** (hire or not) → **Appointment Letter**
→ **Leave Approvals** → **Approve** / **Reject** → teacher told, attendance updated
→ **Look** at Students, Timetable, Marks, Attendance Reports
→ **Faculty / Staff** changes → **Circulars** → **Role Assignments** → **Settings**
→ **Audit Logs** (check what happened) → **Logout**